2. Explain to the patients
3. Make him into left lateral position or right lateral
4. Protect the bed with towel.
5. Wet the shoulder and back.
6. Soap the palm of the hand well and massage with circular movements. So that the tissues under the skin are moved and the circulation is stimulated.
7. Rinse the soap off the skin with the wash cloth, and dry well with the towel.
8. Apply lotion or spirit in the shoulder and back.
9. Apply talcum powder to dry the skin.
10. Leave the bed tidy and the patient comfortable.

If the patient is inconvenient, it is better to use ointment such as Zinc and Caster Oil instead of Spirit and Powder to protect the skin from moisture.

7.6 Care of Foot and Nail

The foot and nails require special attention to prevent infection, odors and an injury to tissue. Problems may result from poor care of the feet and nails. Such as improper trimming, exposure to chemicals and poorly fitted shoes.

Purpose

1. To keep nail harmless
2. To prevent accumulation of dirt under the nail and reduce occurrence of infection.

Care of Nail and Foot

1. Inspect the feet daily including the toes and soles of the feet and the area between the toes.
2. Wash and soak the feet daily using Luke warm water (37 degree C).
3. If the feet perspire, apply a bland foot powder.
4. If dryness is noted along the feet, apply soft oil and rub gently into the skin.
5. File the toe nails straight across and square.
6. Avoid wearing elastic socks and clean daily the socks.
7. Wear properly fitted shoes.
8. Exercise regularly to improve circulation to the lower extremities.

Take Care of Minor Cuts and Infections

Characteristics of a healthy nail

A normal healthy nail is transparent, smooth and convex with pink nail beds and translucent white tips.



Nails grow faster in the summer than in winter

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